

HÖRMANN

A MATH ADVENTURE



Kids won't do worksheets.
They'll fight a boss for two hours.

PLAYABLE TODAY · AGES 5-7 · ANY BROWSER

THE PREMISE

We already know how to
make a child **unable to stop.**

42

attorneys general are suing Meta
for **deliberately designing
addiction** into products used by
children.¹

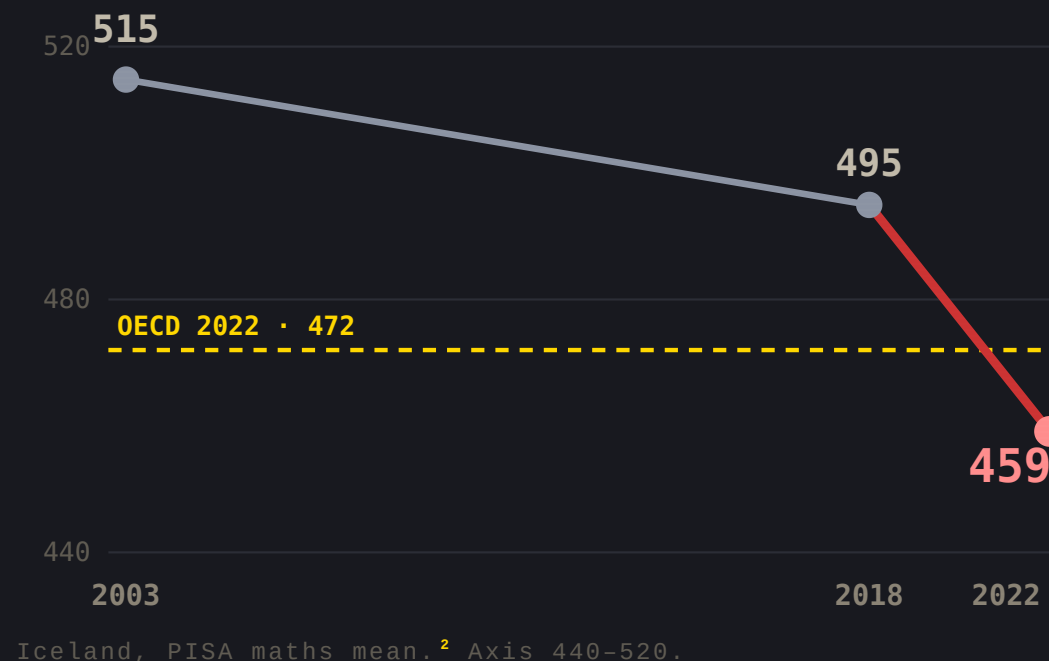
It works. Nobody ever aimed it at anything good.

THE COST

Iceland just posted its worst maths result ever.

34% of Icelandic 15-year-olds lack basic maths proficiency.³

Attention got better at holding them.
School did not.



THE IDEA

Same craft. Better target.

WHAT THE ATTENTION INDUSTRY PERFECTED

- Feedback in under a second
- Always *just barely* winning
- Reward that varies
- A reason to come back tomorrow
- Never let them feel stupid

WHAT A CHILD LEARNING MATHS NEEDS

- Feedback in under a second
- Always *just barely* winning
- Reward that varies
- A reason to come back tomorrow
- Never let them feel stupid

The same list. Nobody aimed it at times tables.

WHY ME

My son quits the second he smells failure.

ADHD, ODD, a high IQ. He will fight a hard boss for two hours. He will not do ten minutes of worksheets.

I make games. So I stopped shopping and started building.

Immediate, or nothing

Children with ADHD need reinforcement that is **immediate, frequent and certain**. Delayed reward never bridges the gap.⁵

THE GAME

Every owl is locked. Maths is the key.



You are a crow

Run, jump, peck, collect. A real platformer.

Owls wear padlocks

Chained, in your way, and needing you.

You free them

Nobody is graded. Something is rescued.

Take the maths out and the game stops working.

Chess ratings, for a **six-year-old's arithmetic.**

Every answer moves the child's rating and the problem's. Difficulty chases the child – not the calendar, not the class average.

3,150

maths problems live in the build, laddered into curriculum steps with per-domain unlocks.

~85%

first-attempt accuracy we tune toward – **a design target**, taken by analogy from the optimal-difficulty literature.⁶

2

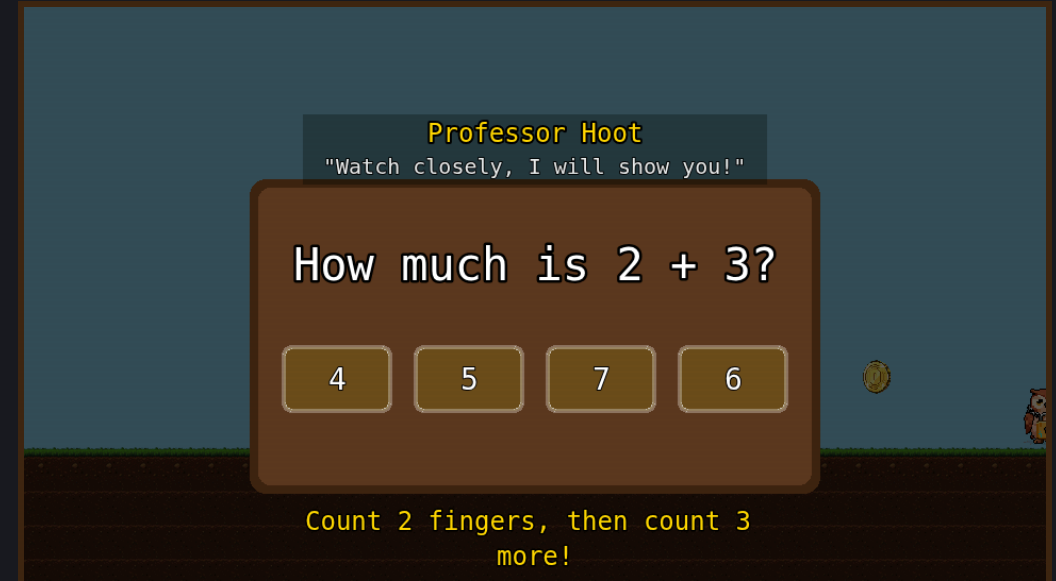
themes ship as **data, not code** – forest and sci-fi already. Reskinning is a content job.

We deleted the moment a child feels stupid.

01 New maths is taught before it is asked. The first attempt cannot hurt you.

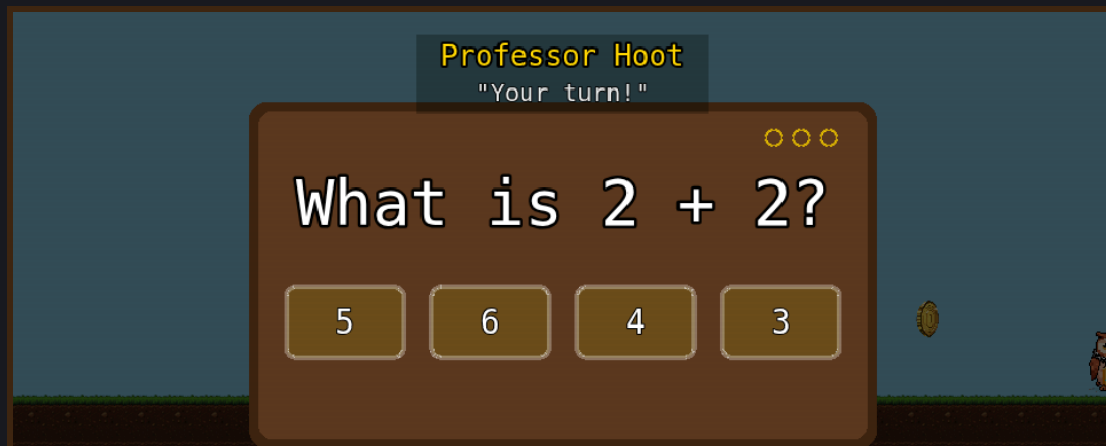
02 A second miss reveals the answer and explains it. A failure ends in teaching.

03 Getting right what you got wrong is the loudest celebration in the game.

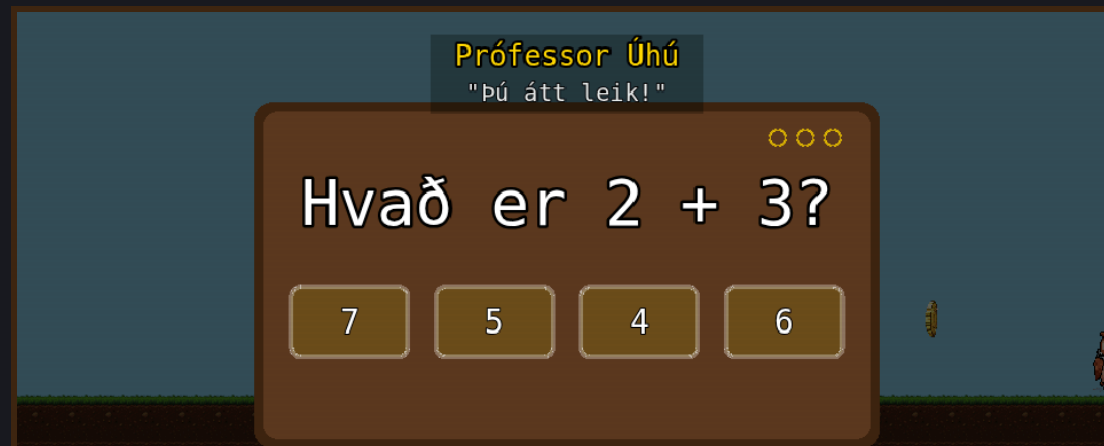


WHERE WE ARE

Not a concept. It runs.



LIVE ENCOUNTER · ENGLISH



SAME BUILD · ÍSLENSKA

Built

3,150 problems · 6 levels · Elo learner model · per-child profiles · English and Icelandic.

Played

One child, near-daily, for months. **n=1, and we say so.** No telemetry yet.

Next

One Icelandic class, playing and giving feedback. [\[pilot status\]](#)

Every screenshot in this deck came out of the running build.

Parents and schools, pulling each other in.

-
- 01 Free at home. A link, not an install. A name and a PIN, no email, no funnel.
 - 02 The child asks for it. The parent asks the school. Demand arrives before the sales call.
 - 03 The school buys it – and sends it home with every parent. One sale, a classroom of new households.
-

The classroom is the cash cow. The kitchen table is the salesman.

THE MODEL

Free while we prove it. Then **both sides pay.**

PARENTS · B2C

- Home subscription, low price, high volume
- Retention data in weeks, not procurement quarters

SCHOOLS · B2B

- Per-pupil annual licence – the cash cow
- Every licence hands us a classroom of parents

TODAY

Free. Prototyping and feedback.

DELIVERY

Web. No COGS, no shipping.

PRICING

2,000 ISK per pupil / year · \$10 per family / month

Each channel sells the other.

Break-even is 6,500 families.

WHAT IT BURNS

6.3m ISK

PER MONTH, TWO PEOPLE

1.75m salary +33% employer cost, each

+35% contract art, academic and admin time

≈ €535k / \$623k a year

WHAT COVERS IT

6,500 subs

AT \$10 A MONTH, NET OF STORE FEES

Or half of Iceland's schools + 2,400 families

Every Icelandic pupil at 2,000 ISK a year covers 125% of it, alone⁹

47,162 pupils sit in 174 schools – 174 sales calls

WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

20,000 subs

= 3.1× BREAK-EVEN

\$1.9m net a year against a \$623k cost base

Iceland's 5-7 band is ~14,000 children – so this is a Nordic number

Every extra sub is ~80% margin. Web delivery, no COGS

Dials: headcount price store cut school penetration Third hire moves burn to 9.4m ISK a month.

20,000 subscribers is not break-even. It is \$1.3m a year.

COMPETITION

The maths leaders are worksheets with sprites.

Prodigy

\$125m raised, tens of millions of learners – an RPG wrapper around a question bank.⁸

SplashLearn

~1,900 activities, pre-K to grade 5. Breadth over depth, and worksheets in the box.⁸

DragonBox

Genuinely good puzzle design, ages 4-14 – but a puzzle set, not a game kids return to.⁸

None of them is a platformer. None speaks Icelandic.

THE TEAM

One builder. Three named gaps.

[your name]

FOUNDER

Shipped the running build
solo: engine, learner
model, content pipeline,
two locales.

Technical co-founder

[STATUS]

Owns sync, scale, apps,
and the telemetry the
research will need.

Artist

[STATUS]

Art direction and the
reskin pipeline. The seat
that makes it wanted.

Teacher + academic

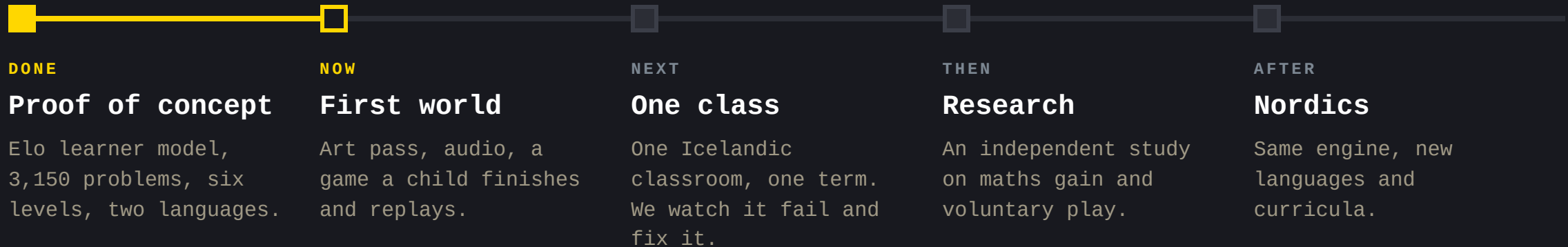
[STATUS]

Speaks the school's
language, and runs the
study that turns claims
into evidence.

Credibility with schools is a hire, not a slide.

THE PLAN

From proof to evidence.



The milestone that matters is a teacher asking for it back.

THE ASK

€600k buys a year.

The year buys **evidence and revenue.**

WHAT IT BUYS · 12 MONTHS

- ▶ Two full-time salaries, fully loaded – 6.3m ISK a month
- ▶ Contract art and academic time, not more headcount
- ▶ The classroom pilot and the efficacy study

WHAT IT PROVES · THEN REVENUE

- ▶ Children choose it at home, unprompted
- ▶ Measured maths gain against a control group
- ▶ First paying schools – and a countable path to 6,500 subs

The method is already proven. We are aiming it.

SOURCES

Every number, traceable.

- 1 42 state and territory attorneys general v. Meta, filed Oct 2023 – a 33-state joint federal suit plus nine individual filings. njoag.gov
- 2 OECD, PISA 2022 Results – Country Note: Iceland. Maths mean 459 (2022), 495 (2018), 515 (2003); OECD average 472; decline predates 2018. oecd.org
- 3 Miðstöð menntunar og skólapjónustu, Helstu niðurstöður PISA 2022 á Íslandi. 66% at or above basic maths proficiency. mms.is
- 4 Wang et al., Effects of digital game-based STEM education on students' learning achievement: a meta-analysis, Int. J. STEM Educ., 2022. 33 studies, N=3,894, ES 0.667. doi 10.1186/s40594-022-00344-0
- 5 Luman et al., Reinforcement Contingency Learning in Children with ADHD, Res. Child Adolesc. Psychopathol., 2019. doi 10.1007/s10802-019-00572-z
- 6 Wilson, Shenhav, Straccia & Cohen, The Eighty Five Percent Rule for optimal learning, Nature Communications 10:4646, 2019. A machine-learning result, used here as design rationale by analogy – not as pedagogy proof. doi 10.1038/s41467-019-12552-4
- 7 Klinkenberg, Straatemeier & van der Maas, Computer adaptive practice of Maths ability..., Computers & Education 57(2), 2011. Math Garden: 3,648 children, 3.5m problems in ten months, ~33% outside school hours. doi 10.1016/j.compedu.2011.02.003
- 8 Competitor figures: Prodigy funding via Tracxn company profile; SplashLearn activity count and reach via its own published materials; DragonBox age range via publisher. Public sources, not independently audited.
- 9 Statistics Iceland, Pupils in compulsory schools 2024: 47,162 pupils, 174 schools. Pre-primary: 20,200+ children (Dec 2024). stati.ce.is
- Product figures – 3,150 problems, 6 levels, Elo learner model, the ~85% target, EN/IS – come from the Hörmann repository's dated snapshot and architecture docs, verified against the running build. Play counts are stated as n=1 because that is what they are.